

That is it, now you can run Linux from a window in the Windows OS. To switch between the virtual machine and the Windows desktop, use the right control key (by default). To toggle the fullscreen mode, press the right control key and [F].

Dual OS installation

As long as you have enough Hard Disk space, it is possible to install two or more Operating Systems and distros on the same computer. The method for installing two or more operating systems is practically the same. What Linux does here is resize the partition to make room for itself. This works the same for a Windows OS, or another Linux Distro.

First, put the CD or DVD in the tray, and restart the machine. Before the OS boots, press [F12]. The loading screen of the distro should show up now. Choose to install the system, and go past the first few steps, which are the same as a fresh installation discussed before. The difference will be at the partitioning stage, where you will have to modify the partitions instead of using the preset partitions. The wording for this option may be different in different distros, but basically, you will have to choose to resize, modify or “make room” in the partition.



The next step is to choose a partition to modify. Choosing the largest partition is a good idea at this point. You might want to break it up into two parts, one for the system, and another for the swap space. Do not try this without backing up your data, although nothing will happen to the data if everything goes fine – it will still be in the regular locations. The only thing you will lose